



No region-locking on Switch

One of the best aspects of the Nintendo Switch's software design is the lack of region-locking. Read more to find out: <http://dgit.in/SwitchFree>

Hangouts Meet and Chat

With the new 'Meet' and 'Chat', Google is basically transforming their Hangouts chat application to take on Slack. <http://dgit.in/GoogleSlack>

Instagram has actually taken it one step further and introduced additional features like tagging friends, swipe up links, live video and more.

What's more, Facebook has taken this feature and spread it across its portfolio of apps like WhatsApp, with 'Status', and Messenger, with its latest Facebook Messenger Day. While they claim to be different, it is hard to spot anything significant that sets them apart, other than a couple of stickers or the platform itself – which might precisely be the reason for user interest to dwindle in the concept of stories altogether! Although, to be fair, we might just be looking at the rise of another super-popular format, like when the newsfeed first came out.

The smarts

One look at the smartphone industry and its products right now will tell you a very blatant tale of 'inspiration' generously being borrowed in every production cycle. In fact, it is quite difficult to pinpoint where it all started and who did it first, but many say that it all began when Apple came out with the iPhone.

Perhaps a better testament to the copying would be the number of lawsuits filed by smartphone manufacturers against each other. Usually, it is something people associate Apple with, but if it were only the Cupertino based tech giant involved, there wouldn't be something called the Smartphone 'Patent wars' (it even has its own Wikipedia page: <http://dgit.in/SPatent-Wars>). Over the years, Sony, Google, Apple, Samsung, Microsoft, Nokia, Motorola, Huawei, LG, ZTE, HTC and other phone manufacturers have been engaged in litigations and counter-litigations based on smartphone patent violations, hence the moniker.

This has affected the customer. An average smartphone buyer, who used to look for a unique smartphone back in the day, will now look for the same features in all phones, as a guarantee towards a safe purchase. Nowadays, almost all smartphones sport a slate/phablet design with little or no dif-



While these models might be dated, not much has changed in smartphone design

ference in the way we use them. Is it because we have reached an optimal design? Or is it just a 'make what sells' phenomenon?

Gaming it

If we were to make a list of things that video games copied from each other, it would be one really long list. Some would say that copying and borrowing inspiration is how genres are formed. While that is true, when one game looks and plays almost exactly like the other, one can't help but wonder if it is a case of outright copying.

In recent examples, the case of Overwatch vs Paladins comes to mind. Note that Overwatch was a hugely successful game and knock-offs and rip-offs aren't uncommon for games that see that level of success. But when the accused is a reputable studio like Hi-Rez Studios, you are bound to get up and take notice. The accusations have actually been flying to and fro, but

with the marketing might of Blizzard you can take a guess at whose version more people have heard about. To get a comprehensive list of the information and quotes available as a comparison, take a look at this reddit post – <http://dgit.in/OvwVSPldns>.

If these debate reminds you of another similar one from a couple of years ago, you're not wrong. Going

back just a few years, the DotA vs LoL debate was rife with accusations from both sides. While fans of the original DotA were busy accusing LoL of copying, LoL fans couldn't get enough of blaming DotA 2 for the copying. Of course, one can say that nobody really lost, since both games are insanely popular and are doing quite well. The debate's attention is now focused on the former example in this section. We wonder what will be next?

Quite Fitting

The wearables market has been a cause of debate for quite a while now. People have given judgements on both side of the fence, calling it the future as well as a failure. But what's neglected is the similarity between most wearables, especially fitness trackers.

Don't get us wrong, there's not much fitness trackers are supposed to do to begin with. But it does get tiring watching every manufacturer tout their



Overwatch's edgelord as compared to Paladin's edgelord